

CURRICULUM AND THE TEACHER
CURRICULUM IN SCHOOLS

“The Sabre-Tooth Curriculum by Harold Benjamin (1939)

The story was written in 1939. Curriculum then, was seen as a tradition of organized knowledge taught in schools of the 19th century. Two centuries later, the concept of a curriculum has broadened to include several modes of thoughts or experiences.

No formal, non-formal or informal education exists without a curriculum. Classrooms will be empty with no curriculum. Teachers will have nothing to do, if there is no curriculum. Curriculum is at the heart of teaching profession. Every teacher is guided by some sort of curriculum in the classroom and in schools.

Seven Types of Curriculum Operating In The School

1. Recommended Curriculum. Almost all curricula found in our schools are recommended. For Basic Education, these are recommended by the Department of Education (DepEd), for Higher Education, by the Commission on Higher Education (CHED) and for vocational education by TESDA. These three government agencies oversee and regulate Philippine Education. The recommendations come in the form of memoranda or policies, standards and guidelines. Other professional organizations or international bodies like UNESCO also recommend curricula in schools.
2. Written Curriculum. This includes documents based on the recommended curriculum. They come in the form of course of study, syllabi, modules, books or instructional guides among others. A packet of this written curriculum is the teacher's lesson plan. The most recent written curriculum is the K to 12 for Philippine Basic Education.
3. Taught Curriculum. From what has been written or planned, the curriculum has to be implemented or taught. The teacher and the learners will put life to the written curriculum. The skill of the teacher to facilitate learning based on the written curriculum with the aid of instructional materials and facilities will be necessary. The taught curriculum will depend largely on the teaching style of the teacher and the learning style of the learners.
4. Supported Curriculum. This is described as support materials that the teacher needs to make learning and teaching meaningful. These include print materials like books, charts, posters, worksheets, or non-print materials like Power Point presentation, movies, slides, models, realias, mock-ups and other electronic illustrations. Supported curriculum also includes facilities where learning occurs outside or inside the four-walled building. These include the playground, science laboratory, audio-visual rooms, zoo, museum, market or the plaza. These are the places where authentic learning through direct experiences occur,
5. Assessed Curriculum. Taught and supported curricula have to be evaluated to find out if the teacher has succeeded or not in facilitating learning. In the process of teaching and at the end of every lesson or teaching episode, an assessment is made. It can either be assessment for learning, assessment as learning or assessment of learning. If the process is to find the progress is to find the progress of learning, then the assessed curriculum is for learning, but if it is to find out how much has been learned or mastered., then it is assessment of learning. Either way, such curriculum is the assessed curriculum.
6. Learned Curriculum. We always believe that if a student changed behaviour, he/she has learned. For example, from a non-reader to a reader or from not knowing to knowing or from disobedient to being obedient. The positive outcome of teaching is an indicator of learning. These are measured by tools in assessment, which can indicate the cognitive, affective and

- psychomotor outcomes. Learned curriculum will also demonstrate higher order and critical thinking and lifelong skills.
7. Hidden/Implicit Curriculum. This curriculum is not deliberately planed, but has a great impact on the behaviour of the learner. Peer influence, school environment, media, parental pressures, societal changes, cultural practices, natural calamities, are some factors that create the hidden curriculum. Teachers should be sensitive and aware of this hidden curriculum. Teachers must have good foresight to include these in written curriculum in order to bring to the surface what are hidden.

THE TEACHER AS A CURRICULARIST
Roles of a Teacher as Curricularist

1. knows the curriculum. Learning begins with knowing. The teacher as a learner starts with about the curriculum, the subject matter or the content. As a teacher, one has to master what are included in the curriculum. It is acquiring academic knowledge both formal (disciplines, logic) or informal (derived from experiences, vicarious, and unintended). It is the mastery of the subject matter. (Knower)
2. writes the curriculum. A classroom teacher takes record of knowledge concepts, subject matter or content. These need to be written or preserved. The teacher writes books, modules, laboratory manuals, instructional guides, and reference materials in paper or electronic media as a curriculum writer or reviewer. (Writer)
3. plans the curriculum. A good curriculum has to be planed. It is the role of the teacher to make a yearly, monthly or daily plan of the curriculum. This will serve as a guide in the implementation of the curriculum. The teacher takes into consideration several factors in planning a curriculum. These factors include the learners, the support material, time, subject matter or content , the desired outcomes, the context of the learners among others. By doing this, the teacher becomes a curriculum planner. (Planner)
4. initiates the curriculum. In cases where the curriculum is recommended to the schools from DepEd, CHED, TESDA,UNESCO, UNICEF or other educational agencies for improvement of quality education, the teacher is obliged to implement. Implementation of a new curriculum requires the open mindedness of the teacher, and the full belief that the curriculum will enhance learning. There will be many constraints and difficulties in doing things first or leading, however, a transformative teacher will never hesitate to try something novel and relevant. (Initiator)
5. innovates the curriculum. Creativity and innovation are hallmarks of an excellent teacher. A curriculum is always dynamic, hence it keeps on changing. A good teacher innovates the curriculum. (Innovator)
6. Implements the curriculum. The curriculum that remains recommended or written will never serve its purpose without implementing it. Thus it is the teacher who implements it. It is here where teaching as a science and art will be observed. It is here where all the elements of the curriculum will come into play. The success of a recommended, well written, and planned curriculum depends on the implementation. (Implementation)
7. Evaluates curriculum. How can one determine if the desired learning outcomes have been achieved? Is the curriculum working? Does it bring the desired results? What do outcomes reveal? Are the learners achieving? Should the curriculum be modified, terminated or continued? These are some few questions that need the help of a curriculum evaluator. That person is the teacher. (Evaluator)

THE TEACHER AS A KNOWER OF CURRICULUM
THE SCHOOL CURRICULUM: DEFINITION, NATURE AND SCOPE

Like many concepts in education, there seems to be no common definition of curriculum. Because of this, the concept of curriculum is sometimes characterized as fragmentary, elusive and confusing. However, the word originates from the Latin word *curere* referring to the oval track upon which Roman chariots raced.

Some Definitions of Curriculum

1. Curriculum is a planned and guided set of learning experiences and intended outcomes, formulated through the systematic reconstruction of knowledge and experiences under the auspices of the school, for the learners' continuous and willful growth in personal social competence. (Daniel Tanner, 1980)
2. It is written document that systematically describes goals planned, objectives, content, learning activities, evaluation procedures and so forth. (Pratt, 1980)
3. The contents of a subject, concepts and tasks to be acquired, planned activities, the desired learning outcomes and experiences, product of culture and an agenda to reform society make up a curriculum (Schubert, 1987)
4. A curriculum includes "all of the experiences that individual learners have in a program of education whose purpose is to achieve broad goals and related specific objectives, which is planned in terms of a framework of theory and research or past and present professional practice." (Hass, 1987)
5. It is a programme of activities (by teachers and pupils) designed so that pupils will attain so far as possible certain educational and other schooling ends or objectives. (Grundy, 1987)
6. It is a plan that consists of learning opportunities for a specific time frame and place, a tool that aims to bring about behavior changes in students as a result of planned activities and includes all learning experiences received by students with the guidance of the school. (Goodland and Su, 1992)
7. It provides answers to three questions: What knowledge, skills and values are most worthwhile? 2. Why are they most worthwhile? 3. How should the young acquire them? (Cronbeth, 1992)

Curriculum from Traditional Points of View

- Robert M. Hutchins views curriculum as "permanent studies" where rules of grammar, reading, rhetoric, logic and mathematics for basic education are emphasized. The 3Rs (Reading, Writing, "rithmetic) should be emphasized in basic education while liberal education should be emphasized in college.
- Arthurr Bestor as an essentialist believes that the mission of the school should be intellectual training, hence curriculum should focus on the fundamental intellectual disciplines of grammar, literature and writing, It should include mathematics, science, history and foreign language.
- Joseph Schwab thinks that the sole source of curriculum is a discipline, thus the subject areas such as Science, Mathematics, Social Studies, English and many more. In college, academic disciplines are labelled as humanities, sciences, languages, mathematics among others. He coined the word discipline as a ruling doctrine for curriculum.
- Phillip Phenix asserts that curriculum should consist entirely of knowledge which comes from various disciplines.

Curriculum from Progressive Points of View

- John Dewey believes that education is experiencing. Reflective thinking is a means that unifies curricular elements that are tested by application.

- Holin Caswell and Kenn Campbell viewed curriculum as all experiences children have under the guidance of teachers.
- Othaniel Smith, William Stanley and Harlan Shore likewise defined curriculum as a sequence of potential experiences, set up in schools for the purpose of disciplining children and youth in group ways of thinking and acting.
- Colin Marsh and George Willis also viewed curriculum as well as all the experiences in the classroom which are planned and enacted by the teacher and also learned by the students.

APPROACHES TO SCHOOL CURRICULUM
Three Ways of Approaching a Curriculum

1. Curriculum as a Content or body of Knowledge.

It is quite common for traditionalists to equate a curriculum as a topic outline, subject matter, or concepts to be included in the syllabus or books. For example, a primary school mathematics curriculum consists of topics on addition, multiplication, subtraction, division, distance, weight and many more. Another example is in school science that involves the study of biological science, physical science, environmental science and earth science. Textbooks tend to begin with biological science such as plants and animals, physical science with the physical elements, force and motion, earth science with the layer and environmental science with the interaction of the biological and physical science and earth's phenomena, climate, vegetation followed by economic activities such as agriculture, mining, industries, urbanization and so forth.

Four Ways of Presenting the Content in the Curriculum

1. Topical Approach, where much content is based on knowledge and experiences are included.
2. Concept Approach with fewer topics in clusters around major and sub-concepts and their interaction, with relatedness emphasized.
3. Thematic Approach as a combination of concepts that develop conceptual structures.
4. Modular Approach that leads to complete units of instruction.

Criteria in the Selection of Content

1. Significance. Content should contribute to ideas, concepts, principles and generalization that should attain the overall purpose of the curriculum. It is significant if content becomes the means of developing cognitive, affective or psychomotor skills of the learner. As education is a way of preserving culture, content will be significant when this will address the cultural context of the learner.
2. Validity. The authenticity of the subject matter forms its validity. Knowledge becomes obsolete with the fast changing times. Thus there is a need for validity check and verification at a regular interval, because content which may be valid in its original form may continue to be valid in the current times.
3. Utility. Usefulness of the content in the curriculum is relative to the learners who are going to use these. Utility can be relative to time. It may have been useful in the past, but may not be useful now or in the future.
4. Learnability. The complexity of the content should be within the range of experiences of the learners. This is based on the psychological principles of learning. Appropriate organization of content standards and sequencing of contents are two basic principles that would influence learnability.
5. Feasibility. Can the subject content be learned within the time allowed, resources available, expertise of the teachers and the nature of the learners? Are there contents of learning which can be learned beyond the formal teaching-learning engagement? Are there opportunities provided to learn these?

6. Interest. Will the learners take interest in the content? Why? Are the contents meaningful? What value will the contents have in the present and future life of the learners? Interest is one of the driving forces for the students to learn better.

Guide in the Selection of the Content in the Curriculum

- 1. Commonly used in the daily life.
- 2. Appropriate to the maturity levels and abilities of the learners.
- 3. Valuable in meeting the needs and competencies of the future career.
- 4. Related to other subject fields or discipline for complementation and integration.
- 5. Important in the transfer of learning to other disciplines.

Basic Principles of Curriculum Content

- 1. Balance. Content should be fairly distributed in depth and breadth. This will guarantee that significant contents should be covered to avoid too much or too little of the contents needed within the time allocation.
- 2. Articulation. As the content complexity progresses with the educational levels, vertically or horizontally, across the same discipline, smooth connections or bridging should be provided.
- 3. Sequence. The logical arrangement of the content refers to sequence or order. This can be done vertically for deepening the content or horizontally for broadening the same content. In both ways, the pattern usually is from easy to complex, what is known to the unknown, what is current to something in the future.
- 4. Integration. Content in the curriculum does not stand alone or isolation. It has some ways of relatedness or connectedness to other contents. Contents should be infused in other discipline whenever possible.
- 5. Continuity. Content when viewed as a curriculum should continuously flow as it was before, to where it is now, and where it will be in the future. It should be perennial. It endures time. Content maybe not be in the same form and substance as seen in the past since changes and developments in curriculum occur. Constant repetition, reinforcement and enhancement of the content are all elements of continuity.

2. Curriculum as a Process

As a process, curriculum links to the content. While content provides materials on what to teach, the process provides curriculum on how to teach the content. When accomplished, the process will result to various curriculum experiences for the learners. The intersection of the content and process is called the Pedagogical Content Knowledge or PCK. It will address the question: If you have this content, how will you teach it? When curriculum is approached as a PROCESS, guiding principles are presented.

- 1. Curriculum process in the form of teaching methods or strategies are means to achieve the end.
- 2. There is no single best process or method. Its effectiveness will depend on the desired learning outcomes, the learners, support material and the teacher.
- 3. Curriculum process should stimulate the learners' desire to develop the cognitive, affective, psychomotor domains in each individual.
- 4. In the choice of methods, learning and teaching styles should be considered.
- 5. Every method or process should result to learning outcomes which can be described as cognitive, affective and psychomotor.
- 6. Flexibility in the use of the process or methods should be considered.

7. Both teaching and learning are the two important processes in the implementation of the curriculum.

3. Curriculum as a Product

The product from the curriculum is a student equipped with the knowledge, skills and values to function effectively and efficiently. The real purpose of education is to bring about significant changes in students' pattern of behaviour. Central to the approach is the formulation of behavioral objectives stated as intended learning outcomes or desired products so that content and teaching methods may be organized and the results evaluated. Products of learning are operationalized as knowledge, skill, and values. Curriculum product is expressed in form of outcomes which are referred to as the achieved learning outcomes.

CURRICULUM DEVELOPMENT: PROCESSES AND MODELS
Curriculum Development Process

- 1. Curriculum planning. Considers the school vision, mission and goals. It also includes the philosophy or strong education belief of the school. All of these will eventually be translated to classroom desired learning outcomes for the learners.
- 2. Curriculum designing is the way curriculum is conceptualized to include the selection and organization of content, the selection and organization of learning experiences or activities and the selection of assessment procedure and tools to measure achieved learning outcomes. It will also include the resources to be utilized and the statement of the learning outcomes.
- 3. Curriculum implementing is putting into action the plan which is based on the curriculum design in the classroom setting or the learning environment. The teacher is the facilitator of learning and, together with the learners, uses the curriculum as design guides to what will transpire in the classroom with the end in view of achieving the intended learning outcomes. Implementing the curriculum is where action takes place.
- 4. Curriculum evaluating determines the extent to which the desired outcomes have been achieved. This procedure is on-going as in finding out the progress of learning (formative) or the mastery of learning (summative). Along the way, evaluation will be determine the factors that have hindered or supported the implementation. It will also pinpoint where improvement can be made and corrective measures, introduced. The result of evaluation is very important for decision making of curriculum planners, and implementers.

Curriculum Development Process Models

- 1. **Ralph Tyler Model: Four Basic Principles. It is based on four fundamental principles which are illustrated as answers to the following questions?**
 - a. What education purposes should schools seek to attain?
 - b. What educational experiences can be provided that are likely to attain these purposes?
 - c. How can these educational experiences be effectively organized?
 - d. How can we determine whether these purposes are being attained or not?

Tyler's model shows that in curriculum development, the following considerations should be made:

- 1. Purposes of the school
- 2. Educational experiences related to the purposes
- 3. Organization of the experience
- 4. Evaluation of the experience

2. **Hilda Taba Model: Grassroots Approach.** She improved the Tyler’s model. She believed that teachers should participate in developing a curriculum. As grassroots approach Taba begins from the bottom, rather than from top as what Tyler proposed. She presented seven major steps to her linear model which are the following:

1. Diagnosis of learners’ needs and expectations of the large society.
2. Formulation of learning objectives.
3. Selection of learning contents
4. Organization of learning contents
5. Selection of learning experiences
6. Determination of what to evaluate and the means of doing it.

3. **Galen Saylor and William Alexander Curriculum Model.** According to them curriculum is a plan of providing sets of learning opportunities to achieve broad educational goals and related specific objectives to an identified population served by a single school center. There are four steps in this model:

1. Goals, Objectives and Domains. Curriculum planner begin by specifying the major educational goals and specific objectives they wish to accomplish. The goals, objectives and domain are identified and chosen based on research findings, accreditation standards, and views of different stakeholders.
2. Curriculum Designing. Designing a curriculum follows after appropriate learning opportunities are determined and how each opportunity is provided.
3. Curriculum Implementation. A designed curriculum is now ready for implementation. Teachers then prepare instructional plans where instructional objectives are specified and appropriate teaching methods and strategies are utilized to achieve the desired learning outcomes among students.
4. Evaluation. The last step of the curriculum model is evaluation. A comprehensive evaluation techniques are used to evaluate the total programme of the school and the curriculum plan, the effectiveness of instruction and the achievement of the students. Through evaluation process, curriculum planner and developers can determine whether or not the goals of the school and the objectives of instruction have been met.

All the models discussed utilised the processes of 1) curriculum planning, 2) curriculum designing, 3) curriculum implementing, and 4) curriculum evaluating.

FOUNDATIONS OF CURRICULUM DEVELOPMENT
Foundations of Curriculum

1. Philosophical Foundations

A. Perennialism

- Aim: To educate the rational person; cultivate intellect
- Role: Teachers assist students to think with reasons (critical thinking HOTS)
- Focus: Classical subjects, literary analysis. Curriculum is enduring
- Trends: Use of great books (Bible, Koran, Classics) and Liberal Arts

B. Essentialism

- Aim: To promote intellectual growth of learners to become competent

- Role: Teachers are sole authorities in the subject area
- Focus: Essential skills of the 3Rs; essential subjects
- Trends: Back to basic, excellence in education, cultural literacy

C. Progressivism

- Aim: Promote democratic social living
- Role: Teacher leads growth and development of lifelong learners
- Focus: Interdisciplinary subjects. Learner-centered, Outcomes-based
- Trends: Equal opportunities for all, Contextualized curriculum, Humanistic education

D. Reconstructionism

- Aim: To improve and reconstruct society. Education for change
- Role: Teacher acts as agent of change and reforms
- Focus: Present and future educational landscape
- Trends: School and curricular reform, Global education, Collaboration and Convergence, Standards and Competences

2. Historical Foundations.

1. Franklin Bobbit (1876-1956).

- He started the curriculum movement
- Curriculum is a science that emphasizes students’ needs
- Curriculum prepares learners for adult life.
- Objectives and activities should group together when tasks are clarified.

2. Werret Charters (1875-1952)

- Like Bobbit, he posited that curriculum is a science and emphasizes students’ needs
- Objectives and activities should match. Subject matter or content relates to objectives

3. William Killpatrick (1875-1952)

- Curricula are purposeful activities which are child- centered
- The purpose of the curriculum is child development and growth. He introduced the project method where teacher and student plan the activities.
- Curriculum develops social relationships and small group instruction.

4. Harold Rugg (1886-1960)

- Curriculum should develop the whole child. IT IS CHILD CENTERED.
- With the statement of objectives and related learning activities, curriculum should produce outcomes.
- Emphasized social studies and suggested that the teacher plans in advance.

5. Hollis Caswell (1901-1989)

- Curriculum is organized around social functions of themes, organized knowledge and learner’s interest.
- Curriculum, instruction and learning are interrelated
- Curriculum is a set of experiences. Subject matter is developed around social functions and learning interests.

6. Ralph Tyler (1902-1994)

- Curriculum is a science and an extension of school's philosophy. It is based on students' needs and interest.
- Curriculum is always related to instruction. Subject matter is organized in terms of knowledge, skills and values.
- The process emphasizes problem solving. Curriculum aims to educate generalists and not specialists.

7. **Hilda Taba (1902-1967)**

- She contributed to the theoretical and pedagogical foundations of concepts development and critical thinking in social studies curriculum.
- She helped lay foundation for diverse student population

8. **Peter Oliva (1992-2012)**

- He described how curriculum change is a cooperative endeavor.
- Teachers and curriculum specialist constitute the professional core of planners.
- Significant improvement is achieved though group activity.

3. **Psychological Foundation of Curriculum**

1. **Ivan Pavlov (1849-1936)**

- He is the Father of the Classical Conditioning Theory, the S-R Theory
- The key to learning is early years of life is to train them what you want them to become.
- S-R Theory is a foundation of learning practice called indoctrination.

2. **Edward Thorndike (1874-1949)**

- He championed the Connectionism Theory

3. **Robert Gagne (1916-2002)**

- He proposed the Hierarchical Learning Theory. Learning follows a hierarchy

4. **Jean Piaget (1996-1980)**

- Theories of Jean Piaget
 - Cognitive development has stages from birth to maturity:
 - Sensorimotor stage (0-2), preoperational stage (2-7)
 - concrete operations stage (7-11) and formal operations (11- onward)

5. **Lev Vygotsky (1896-1934)**

- Theories of Lev Vygotsky
 - Socio-cultural development theory

6. **Howard Gardner**

- Gardner's Multiple Intelligences
- Humans have several different ways of processing information and these ways are relatively independent of one another

7. **Daniel Goleman**

- Emotion contains the power to affect action.

8. **Gestalt**

- Gestalt Theory
 - Learning is explained in terms of “wholeness” of the problem

9. **Abraham Maslow (1902-1970)**

- He advanced the Self-Actualization Theory and classic theory of human needs

10. **Carl Rogers (1902-1987)**

Non-directive and Therapeutic Learning

11. **John Dewey (1859-1952)**

Considered two fundamental elements - schools and civil society - to be major topics needing attention and reconstruction to encourage experimental intelligence and plurality.

12. **Alvin Toffler**

Wrote the book Future Shock
Believed that knowledge should prepare students for the future

CRAFTING THE CURRICULUM
THE TEACHER AS A CURRICULUM DESIGNER

FUNDAMENTALS OF CURRICULUM DESIGNING

General Axioms as a Guide in Curriculum Development (Oliva, 2003)

1. Curriculum change is inevitable, necessary, and desirable. Curriculum is dynamic.
2. Curriculum is a product of its time. Curriculum responds changes brought about by current social forces, educational reforms, principles of new knowledge, etc.
3. Curriculum changes made earlier can exist concurrently with newer curriculum changes. A revision in curriculum starts and ends slowly. The changes that occur can coexist and oftentimes overlap for long periods of time.
4. Curriculum change depends on people who will implement the change. The teachers are the implementers of the curriculum , it is best that they should design and own the changes.
5. Curriculum development is a cooperative group activity. Consultation with stakeholders is necessary.
6. Curriculum development is a decision-making process made from choices of alternatives. A curriculum designer or developer must decide what contents to teach, philosophy or point of view to support, how to provide for multicultural groups, what methods or strategies, and what type of evaluation to use.
7. Curriculum development is an on-going process. Continuous monitoring, examination, evaluation and improvement of curricula are to be considered in the design of curriculum.
8. Curriculum development is more effective if it is a comprehensive process, rather than a “piecemeal”. Curriculum design is based on careful plan, with clearly established learning outcomes, support resources and needed time.
9. Curriculum development is more effective when it follows a systematic process. A curriculum design is composed of desired outcomes, subject matter content complemented with references, set of procedures, needed materials and resources and evaluation procedure which can be placed in a matrix.
10. Curriculum development starts from where the curriculum is. An existing design is a good starting point for any teacher who plans to enhance and enrich a curriculum.

Elements or Components of a Curriculum Design

There are many labels or names for curriculum design. Some would call it a syllabus , or a lesson plan. Some would call it a unit plant or a course design. Whatever is the name of the design, the common components for all of them are almost the same.

Let us take the Lesson Plan as a miniscule curriculum. A lesson plan or teaching guide includes (1) Intended Learning Outcomes (ILO) or Desired Learning Outcome (DLO) formerly labelled as behavioural objectives, (2) Subject Matter or Content, (3) Teaching and Learning Methods, and (4) Assessment Evaluation.

APPROACHES TO CURRICULUM DESIGN

Types of Curriculum Designs

1. **Subject-Centered Design.** It focuses on the content of the curriculum. Subject - centered curriculum design has also some variations which is focused on the individual subject, specific discipline and a combination of subjects or disciplines which are a broad field or interdisciplinary.

- 1.1. Subject Design. What subject are you teaching? What subject are you taking?
- 1.2. Discipline design. It is related to the subject design that centers only on the cluster content, but discipline design focuses on academic disciplines. Discipline refers to specific knowledge learned through a method which the scholars use to study a specific content of their fields. This design model of curriculum is often used in college, but not in the elementary or secondary levels.
- 1.3. Correlation design. Subjects are related to one another and still maintain their identity.
- 1.4. Broad field design/interdisciplinary. This design was made to cure compartmentalization of the separate subject subjects and integrate the contents that are related to one another.

2. **Learner-Centered Design.**

- 2.1. Child-Centered design. This curriculum design is anchored on the needs and interests of the child.
- 2.2. Experience-centered design. This design is similar to child-centered design. Experiences of the learners is used as starting point of the curriculum.
- 2.3. Humanistic design. The development of self is the ultimate objective of learning. It stresses the whole person and the integration of thinking, feeling and doing.

3. **Problem-Centered Design.** Generally, problem-centered design draws on social problems, needs, interest and abilities of the learners.

- 3.1. Life situations design. What makes the design unique is that the contents are organized in ways that allow students to clearly view problem areas. The connection of subject matter to real situations increases the relevance of the curriculum.
- 3.2. Core problem design. It centers on general education and the problems are based on the common human activities.

Approaches to Curriculum Design

1. **Child or Learner-Centered Approach.** Child or learner is the center of the educational process. The curriculum is constructed based on the needs, interest, purposes and abilities of the learners.

Principles of Child-Centered Curriculum Approach

- Acknowledge and respect the fundamental rights of the child.
- Make all the activities revolve around the over-all development of the learner.

- Consider the uniqueness of every learner in a multicultural classroom.
- Consider using differentiated instruction or teaching.
- Provide a motivating supportive learning environment for all the learner.

2. **Subject Centered Approach.** This is anchored on a curriculum design which prescribes separate distinct subjects for every educational level: basic education, higher education, or vocational principles-technical education. This approach considers the following:

- The primary focus is the subject matter.
- The emphasis is on bits and pieces of information which may be detached from life.
- The subject serves as a means of identifying problems of living.
- Learning means accumulation of content, or knowledge.
- Teacher's role is to dispense the content.

3. **Problem- Centered Approach.** This approach is based on a design which assumes that in a process of living, children experience problems. This approach is characterized by the following views and beliefs:

- The learners are capable of directing and guiding themselves in resolving problems, thus developing the learner to be independent.
- The learners are prepared to assume their civic responsibilities through direct participation in different activities.
- The curriculum leads the learners in the recognition of concerns and problems in seeking solutions.

CURRICULUM MAPPING

Curriculum mapping is a process or procedure that follows curriculum designing. It is done before curriculum implementation or the operationalization of the written curriculum. Curriculum mapping can be done by teacher alone, a group of teachers teaching the same subject, the department, the whole school or district or the whole educational system. Some curricularists would describe curriculum mapping as making a map to success. There are common questions that are asked by different stakeholders, like teachers, colleagues, parents, school officials and the community as well. These questions may include:

- 1. What do my students learn?
- 2. What do they study in the first quarter?
- 3. What are they studying in the school throughout the year?
- 4. Do my co-teachers who handle the same subject, cover the same content? Achieve the same outcomes? Use similar strategies?
- 5. How do I help my students understand the connections between my subjects within the year? Next Year?

Suggested Steps to Follow in Curriculum Mapping

- 1. Make a matrix or a spread sheet.
- 2. Place timeline that you need to cover. (one quarter, one semester, one year). This should be independent on time frame of a particular curriculum that was written.
- 3. Enter the intended learning outcomes, skills needed to be taught or achieved at the end of the teaching.
- 4. Enter in the same matrix the content areas/subject areas to be covered.
- 5. Aligned and name each resource available such as textbooks, workbooks, module next to subject areas.
- 6. Enter the teaching-learning methods to be used to achieve the outcomes.

- 7. Align and enter the assessment procedure and tools to the intended learning outcomes, content areas, and resources.
- 8. Circulate the map among all involved personnel for their inputs.
- 9. Revise and refine map based on suggestions and distribute to all concerned.

IMPLEMENTING THE CURRICULUM
THE TEACHER AS CURRICULUM IMPLEMENTER AND MANAGER

IMPLEMENTING THE DESIGNED CURRICULUM A CHANGE
PROCESS.

Curriculum Implementation Defined

- 1. This is the phase where the teacher action takes place. It means putting into practice the written curriculum that has been designed in syllabi, course study, curricular guides, and subjects. It is a process wherein the learners acquire the planned or intended knowledge, skills, and attitudes that are aimed at enabling the same learners to function effectively in society. (SADC M0E Africa, 2000)
- 2. Ornstein and Hunkins in 1998 defined curriculum implementation as the interaction between the curriculum that has been written and planned and the persons (teachers) who are in charge to deliver it.
- 3. Loucks and Lieberman (1983) define curriculum implementation as the trying out of a new practice and what it looks like when actually used in a school system. It simply means that implementation should bring the desired change and improvement.

Categories of Curriculum Change

- 1. Substitution. The current curriculum will be replaced or substituted by a new one.
- 2. Alteration. There is a minor change to the current or existing curriculum.
- 3. Restructuring. Major change or modification in the school system. Example is the K to 12 curriculum.
- 4. Perturbations. These are changes that are disruptive, but teachers have to adjust to them within a fairly short time.
- 5. Value orientation. This is a type of curriculum change through which is given to the teachers in response to shift in emphasis.

IMPLEMENTING A CURRICULUM DAILY IN THE CLASSROOM

- I. Objectives
- II. Subject Matter
- III. Procedure
- IV. Assessment
- V. Assignment